**PEW RESEARCH CENTER**
**APRIL 28-MAY 1, 2011 OMNIBUS**
**FINAL TOPLINE**
**N=1,006**

**ASK ALL:**

PEW.1 As I read a list of some stories covered by news organizations this past week, please tell me if you happened to follow each news story very closely, fairly closely, not too closely, or not at all closely. First, **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE;] [IF NECESSARY** "Did you follow **[ITEM]** very closely, fairly closely, not too closely or not at all closely?"**]**

| | Very closely | Fairly closely | Not too closely | Not at all closely | **(VOL.)** DK/Ref |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| a. News about Barack Obama's birthplace and birth certificate | | | | | |
| April 28-May 1, 2011 | 18 | 19 | 27 | 35 | 1 |
| b. The rising price of gas and oil | | | | | |
| April 28-May 1, 2011 | 51 | 26 | 13 | 10 | 1 |
| April 14-17, 2011 | 53 | 25 | 11 | 11 | * |
| March 17-20, 2011 | 46 | 28 | 14 | 12 | * |
| **TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:** | | | | | |
| February 24-27, 2011: *The rising price of oil* | 50 | 29 | 13 | 8 | * |
| June 27-30, 2008 | 57 | 26 | 11 | 5 | 1 |
| March 7-10, 2008 | 43 | 33 | 12 | 11 | 1 |
| November 9-12, 2007 | 44 | 28 | 14 | 13 | 1 |
| October 17-20, 2008: *The falling price of gas and oil* | 53 | 33 | 11 | 3 | * |
| July 3-7, 2008: *The rising price of gasoline* | 62 | 25 | 8 | 4 | 1 |
| June 6-9, 2008 | 66 | 19 | 7 | 7 | 1 |
| May 22-25, 2008 | 65 | 22 | 9 | 4 | * |
| May 16-19, 2008 | 64 | 21 | 10 | 4 | 1 |
| May 2-5, 2008 | 63 | 23 | 9 | 4 | 1 |
| April 25-28, 2008 | 62 | 23 | 10 | 5 | * |
| May 24-27, 2007 | 52 | 29 | 10 | 8 | 1 |
| May 18-21, 2007[1] | 48 | 27 | 16 | 8 | 1 |
| August, 2006[2] | 60 | 26 | 7 | 5 | 2 |
| June, 2006 | 58 | 26 | 10 | 5 | 1 |
| May, 2006 | 69 | 21 | 6 | 3 | 1 |
| April, 2006 | 65 | 22 | 8 | 4 | 1 |
| December, 2005 | 61 | 27 | 7 | 4 | 1 |
| Early November, 2005 | 61 | 27 | 9 | 2 | 1 |
| Late October, 2005 | 67 | 23 | 7 | 3 | * |
| Early October, 2005 | 65 | 25 | 6 | 3 | 1 |
| Early September, 2005 | 71 | 19 | 7 | 3 | * |
| Mid-May, 2005 | 58 | 27 | 9 | 5 | 1 |
| Mid-March, 2005 | 50 | 32 | 13 | 5 | * |
| Mid-October, 2004 | 64 | 22 | 8 | 5 | 1 |
| August, 2004 | 52 | 29 | 10 | 8 | 1 |
| July, 2004 | 56 | 25 | 11 | 7 | 1 |
| June, 2004 | 58 | 26 | 9 | 6 | 1 |
| April, 2004 | 46 | 30 | 15 | 8 | 1 |
| Early April, 2004 | 58 | 23 | 10 | 8 | 1 |
| Mid-March, 2004 | 47 | 27 | 14 | 10 | 2 |
| September, 2003 | 45 | 27 | 15 | 11 | 1 |
| March, 2003 | 52 | 27 | 11 | 9 | 1 |

[1] For May 18-21, 2007 the item was not asked as part of a list.

[2] From October, 2000 to August, 2006, the story was listed as "The high price of gasoline these days." From August, 1990 to June, 2000, the story was listed as "Recent increases in the price of gasoline."

**PEW.1 CONTINUED…**

| | Very closely | Fairly closely | Not too closely | Not at all closely | (VOL.) DK/Ref |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| February, 2003 | 53 | 25 | 12 | 9 | 1 |
| June, 2001 | 56 | 31 | 7 | 5 | 1 |
| May, 2001 | 61 | 26 | 6 | 6 | 1 |
| Early October, 2000 | 56 | 25 | 12 | 6 | 1 |
| June, 2000 | 61 | 25 | 9 | 5 | * |
| March, 2000 | 58 | 28 | 10 | 4 | * |
| October, 1990 | 62 | 26 | 8 | 4 | * |
| September, 1990 | 56 | 28 | 11 | 5 | * |
| August, 1990 | 57 | 27 | 10 | 5 | 1 |
| c. Anti-government protests and violence in some Middle Eastern countries | | | | | |
| April 28-May 1, 2011 | 18 | 29 | 25 | 27 | 1 |
| **TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:** | | | | | |
| April 21-25, 2011: *The currents situation and events in Libya* | 21 | 35 | 20 | 22 | 1 |
| April 14-17, 2011 | 21 | 30 | 25 | 23 | 1 |
| April 7-10, 2011 | 28 | 35 | 21 | 16 | * |
| March 31-April 3, 2011: *Military air strikes in Libya by the U.S. and its allies* | 37 | 31 | 17 | 14 | 1 |
| March 24-27, 2011 | 33 | 34 | 17 | 15 | * |
| March 17-20, 2011: *The conflict between rebels and government forces in Libya* | 26 | 28 | 21 | 23 | 1 |
| March 10-13, 2011: *Growing violence in Libya* | 29 | 29 | 21 | 20 | * |
| March 3-6, 2011 | 31 | 31 | 18 | 19 | 1 |
| February 24-27, 2011 | 38 | 30 | 15 | 16 | * |
| February 17-20, 2011: *News about the situation in Egypt* | 34 | 32 | 17 | 16 | 1 |
| February 17-20, 2011: *Anti-government protests in other Middle Eastern and North African nations* | 20 | 30 | 22 | 28 | 1 |
| February 10-13, 2011: *Anti-government protests in Egypt and the resignation of President Hosni Mubarak* | 39 | 31 | 14 | 15 | 1 |
| February 3-6, 2011: *Anti-government protests in Egypt and other Middle Eastern countries* | 32 | 35 | 16 | 18 | * |
| January 27-30, 2011 | 17 | 26 | 21 | 35 | * |
| January 20-23, 2011: *Political instability in Tunisia following the collapse of the government* | 7 | 15 | 25 | 53 | 1 |
| January, 2007: *The U.S. air strikes on suspected terrorist sites in Somalia* | 17 | 32 | 27 | 23 | 1 |
| May, 1999: *NATO air strikes against Serbian forces* | 32 | 38 | 19 | 10 | 1 |
| Late April, 1999 | 41 | 39 | 13 | 7 | * |
| April, 1999 | 41 | 37 | 16 | 6 | 0 |
| March, 1999: *NATO air strikes against Serbian forces in Kosovo* | 43 | 32 | 15 | 9 | 1 |
| August, 1998: *U.S. military strikes against sites linked to terrorists in Afghanistan and Sudan* | 44 | 35 | 13 | 8 | * |
| July 10-24, 1986: *The U.S. air strike against Libya* | 58 | 27 | 11 | 3 | 1 |

**PEW.1 CONTINUED…**

| | Very closely | Fairly closely | Not too closely | Not at all closely | **(VOL.)** DK/Ref |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| d. Deadly storms in the South | | | | | |
| April 28-May 1, 2011 | 45 | 29 | 14 | 12 | 1 |
| **TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:** | | | | | |
| April 21-25, 2011: *Deadly storms in the South and Midwest* | 29 | 33 | 18 | 20 | * |
| June 13-16, 2008: *A tornado that killed four Boy Scouts at a camp in Iowa* | 32 | 35 | 17 | 16 | * |
| May 30-June 2, 2008: *Midwest*[3] | 30 | 33 | 21 | 15 | 1 |
| February 8-11, 2008: *South and Midwest* | 25 | 42 | 19 | 13 | 1 |
| May 11-14, 2007: *Tornadoes and floods in the Midwest* | 22 | 35 | 23 | 19 | 1 |
| March 2-5, 2007: *South and Midwest* | 33 | 38 | 18 | 11 | * |
| May, 1999: *Oklahoma and Kansas* | 38 | 40 | 15 | 6 | 1 |
| e. The announcement that Leon Panetta would become Secretary of Defense and David Petraeus would become Director of the CIA | | | | | |
| April 28-May 1, 2011 | 9 | 17 | 22 | 50 | 1 |
| **TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:** | | | | | |
| January 6-9, 2011: *Changes to Barack Obama's White House staff* | 19 | 34 | 18 | 28 | 1 |
| January 23-26, 2009: *Hillary Clinton becoming Secretary of State* | 24 | 30 | 24 | 22 | * |
| January 9-12, 2009: *Barack Obama's appointments and plans for his administration* | 30 | 37 | 21 | 12 | * |
| January 2-4, 2009 | 32 | 35 | 16 | 17 | * |
| December 12-15, 2008 | 30 | 34 | 20 | 16 | * |
| December 5-8, 2008 | 36 | 38 | 15 | 11 | * |
| November 21-24, 2008: *Plans for the new Obama administration* | 49 | 24 | 15 | 12 | * |
| November 14-17, 2008 | 32 | 37 | 16 | 15 | * |
| November 7-10, 2008 | 39 | 30 | 17 | 14 | * |
| August 30-September 2, 2007: *Attorney General Alberto Gonzales' resignation* | 16 | 28 | 23 | 33 | * |
| August 17-20, 2007: *Karl Rove's resignation from his position in the White House* | 14 | 20 | 23 | 42 | 1 |
| Mid-November, 2006: *The resignation of Secretary of Defense Donald Rumsfeld* | 30 | 30 | 21 | 18 | 1 |
| January, 2001: *George W. Bush's cabinet choices and other high-level appointments* | 26 | 32 | 24 | 17 | 1 |
| January, 1993: *Bill Clinton's cabinet choices and other high-level appointments* | 24 | 42 | 22 | 11 | 1 |
| December, 1991: *The resignation of White House Chief of Staff John Sununu* | 8 | 25 | 31 | 36 | 0 |
| f. The wedding of Prince William and Kate Middleton in England | | | | | |
| April 28-May 1, 2011 | 16 | 19 | 25 | 39 | * |
| April 21-25, 2011: *The upcoming wedding of Prince William and Kate Middleton in England* | 8 | 13 | 25 | 53 | * |
| **TREND FOR COMPARISON:** | | | | | |
| May 9-12, 2008: *The wedding of George Bush's daughter Jenna* | 4 | 7 | 25 | 63 | 1 |

[3] March 2-5, 2007 through May 30-June 2, 2008 asked about "Violent storms and tornadoes" in each region. May, 1999 asked about "Tornadoes in Oklahoma and Kansas."

**ASK ALL:**

PEW.2 Which ONE of the stories I just mentioned have you followed most closely, or is there another story you've been following MORE closely? [**DO NOT READ LIST. ACCEPT ONLY ONE RESPONSE.]**

| Apr 28-May 1 2011 | |
|---|---|
| 30 | Deadly storms in the South |
| 24 | The rising price of gas and oil |
| 9 | The wedding of Prince William and Kate Middleton in England |
| 8 | Anti-government protests and violence in some Middle Eastern countries |
| 8 | News about Barack Obama's birthplace and birth certificate |
| 1 | The announcement that Leon Panetta would become Secretary of Defense and David Petraeus would become Director of the CIA |
| 8 | Some other story **(VOL.)** |
| 12 | Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)** |

**NO QUESTIONS PEW.3-PEW.5**

**ASK ALL:**

PEW.6 Do you think news organizations are giving too much coverage, too little coverage or the right amount of coverage to each of the following? **[READ AND RANDOMIZE]**

| | Too much coverage | Too little coverage | Right amount of coverage | **(VOL.)** DK/Ref |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| a. The wedding of Prince William and Kate Middleton | | | | |
| April 28-May 1, 2011 | 64 | 2 | 29 | 5 |
| April 21-25, 2011: The upcoming wedding of Prince William and Kate Middleton | 64 | 4 | 25 | 7 |
| **TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:** | | | | |
| July 29-August 1, 2010: *The wedding of Chelsea Clinton*[4] | 58 | 8 | 25 | 9 |

**ABC News Poll October, 1981**

*Now, I'm going to mention some news events from the recent past. After each tell me whether you think television news gave the event too much attention, not enough attention or about the right amount of attention…*

| | Too much attention | Not enough attention | About the right amount of attention | **(VOL.)** DK/ No opinion |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| The wedding of Prince Charles and Lady Diana in England[5] | 61 | 2 | 34 | 3 |

| | Too much coverage | Too little coverage | Right amount of coverage | **(VOL.)** DK/Ref |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| b. Barack Obama releasing a more detailed version of his birth certificate | | | | |
| April 28-May 1, 2011 | 54 | 10 | 27 | 9 |

**NO ITEM c**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| d. The rising price of gas and oil<br>April 28-May 1, 2011 | 13 | 39 | 44 | 5 |

[4] Chelsea Clinton married on July 31, 2010, during the field period.

[5] The October, 1981 ABC News poll asked a list of five recent events. Other events not shown here.

**ASK ALL:**

PEW.7 Many news organizations published copies of Barack Obama's more detailed birth certificate in print or posted it online. Did you look at Barack Obama's birth certificate closely, not closely, or did you not look at it at all?

| Apr 28-May 1 2011 | |
|---|---|
| 11 | Closely |
| 21 | Not closely |
| 68 | Did not look at it |
| * | Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)** |

**ASK ALL FRIDAY, APRIL 29, THROUGH SUNDAY, MAY 1 [N=799]:**

PEW.8 Did you watch the wedding of Prince William and Kate Middleton, or not?

| Apr 28-May 1 2011 | | **TREND FOR COMPARISON** *Do you plan to watch* Apr 21-25 2011 | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 34 | Yes | 19 | Yes |
| 65 | No | 75 | No |
| * | Refused **(VOL.)** | 5 | Maybe/Not sure **(VOL.)** |
| | | * | Refused **(VOL.)** |

Now a different type of question…

**ASK ALL:**

PEWWP.1 What do you think is the main reason gasoline prices have gone up recently? **[RECORD FIRST MENTION; DO NOT PROBE]**[6]

| April 28-May 1 2011 | |
|---|---|
| **31** | **NET: GREED/OIL COMPANIES/SPECULATION** |
| 11 | Greed |
| 7 | Oil companies |
| 7 | Speculators/Wall Street |
| 3 | OPEC/Middle Eastern countries/Oil producers |
| 1 | Because they can |
| 1 | Gouging |
| **19** | **Wars/unrest in Libya/the Middle East** |
| **14** | **NET: POLITICS/POLICY** |
| 5 | United States not drilling enough/using its own oil |
| 5 | Other political reasons/Government |
| 4 | President Obama/Obama Administration |
| **12** | **ECONOMIC/MARKET REASONS** |
| 4 | Market issue—Competition with other countries for oil/Demand |
| 4 | The economy |
| 2 | Time of year/Season |
| 2 | Increasing price of crude oil |
| 1 | Declining value of the dollar/Monetary policy |
| **1** | **Corruption** |
| 9 | Other |
| 14 | No answer |

[6] PEWWP.1 asked in conjunction with *The Washington Post*.

***TREND FOR COMPARISON***

*What do you think is the main reason gasoline prices have gone up recently?* ***[RECORD FIRST MENTION; DO NOT PROBE]***

| | ABC News/ Washington Post | |
|---|---|---|
| | May 2008 | May 2007 |
| Oil companies/Greed/Profit | 30 | 33 |
| Iraq war | 12 | 15 |
| Bush administration | 10 | 7 |
| OPEC/Foreign oil producers | 9 | 4 |
| Market forces | 8 | 2 |
| Supply—less gas available/Gas production problems | 7 | 8 |
| Demand—people driving more | 5 | 3 |
| Other political reasons | 4 | 8 |
| Time of year/Season | * | 2 |
| Other | 5 | 6 |
| No opinion | 10 | 12 |